# VENDRA

## UI / UX redesign plan

A professional clothing and footwear storefront, built only on what the backend really provides.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Scope** | Every page in Frontend/src (9 routes) plus 2 new frontend-only pages (Search results, 404). |
| **Backend** | Not touched. No endpoint is invented. Anything the backend cannot do is not shown in the UI. |
| **Status** | PLAN ONLY. Nothing in the project has been modified. Implementation starts after you approve. |
| **Your inputs needed** | See section 11 - five short decisions (palette, animation library, policy strip, new pages, Razorpay key). |

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# 1. What I found in the current UI

I read all pages, the router, the SCSS design tokens, the Redux/API layer and the backend routes and models. The app works end to end (browse, variants, cart, Razorpay checkout, order success, seller tools), but the UI has these problems:

| Problem | Where | Why it matters |
|---|---|---|
| **Two visual languages** | Home, Product, Cart, Order Success use a light warm theme (_variables.scss). Login, Register, Create Product, Seller Dashboard still use the old dark purple/neon 'luxury' theme. | The site feels like two different products. |
| **Fake data baked into pages** | Home sample products, Dashboard sample products and KPIs (1,420 views, 84 inquiries, +2 this month, 3 Active Salons), fake MRP (price x 2.85 and a default '65% OFF'), static size chart, fake currency rates. | Shows information the backend never supplied. Misleads shoppers and sellers. |
| **Controls with no backend** | Wishlist hearts, promo code, cart trash button (only shows a toast), Apple sign-in, Forgot password, Remember me, seller status filter, Archive product, Buy Now. | Buttons that look real but do nothing. |
| **Copy that does not fit a clothing shop** | 'Haute couture', 'provenance ledger', 'cryptographic tags', 'escrow vault', 'archival', 'salon', 'atelier'. | Reads like an auction/crypto marketplace, not an everyday fashion store. |
| **Visible bugs** | Home renders the literal text '-- Quick View Modal --' on the page; Quick View modal is dead code; Create Product links to /my-listings (route does not exist); dead footer anchors (#terms, #escrow, #support); index.html title says 'Register & Join'. | Looks unfinished. |
| **Search is basic** | One text box, filters on title/description/seller-id only, no suggestions, no highlight, no recent searches, no keyboard support, '(Cmd+K)' badge that does nothing. | Core e-commerce discovery feature is weak. |
| **Inline styles / duplicated code** | Many style={{}} blocks and !important overrides to fight the old theme. | Hard to maintain; blocks a consistent redesign. |
| **No 404, no skeletons on Home** | Unknown URLs show a blank router error; Home shows nothing while loading. | Poor perceived quality. |

# 2. Ground rules and the backend capability map

- **No hardcoded content.** Products, prices, images, stock, attributes, seller and user data all come from the API. Nothing is invented to fill space.
- **No backend = no UI.** If an endpoint or model field does not exist, the control is removed rather than faked.
- **Presentation-only copy** (button labels, empty states, the shipping/returns strip) is kept in one editable file, **src/config/storefront.js**, so it is never scattered or mistaken for data.
- **Backend and API contracts stay exactly as they are.** Redux slices and hooks are reused; I only add small selectors/helpers on the frontend.

### What the backend really supports (from routes and models)

| Capability | Backend | UI decision |
|---|---|---|
| **List all products / one product** | GET /api/products, GET /api/products/:id | **Use.** Newest-first, price sort, gallery, variants. |
| **Variants (images, stock, price, attributes map)** | Product.variants[] | **Use.** Colour swatches, size pills, stock badge, per-variant price. |
| **Search** | No endpoint | **Client-side search** over the already fetched product list (title, description, attribute values). |
| **Categories (men / women / shoes)** | No category field on Product | **Do not show category tabs.** Old text-guessing filter is removed. Browse instead by newest, price, and variant attributes (e.g. Size, Colour) that sellers actually enter. |
| **Cart add / +1 / -1 / list** | POST add, PATCH increment, PATCH decrement, GET / | **Use.** |
| **Cart remove item** | No endpoint | **Remove trash button** (quantity - at 1 stays at 1). |
| **Promo / coupon** | No endpoint | **Remove promo box.** |
| **Wishlist** | No endpoint | **Remove hearts.** |
| **Checkout (Razorpay create + verify)** | POST payment/create/order, verify | **Use.** Restyle the flow, same logic. |
| **Order lookup by id** | Route missing (frontend already falls back to the saved snapshot) | **Keep fallback.** Success page shows only verified data. |
| **Auth: register, login, get-me, Google** | Yes | **Use.** No Apple, no Forgot password, no Remember me. |
| **Logout / profile / order history** | No endpoint | **Not shown.** |
| **Seller: create product, list own products, add variant** | Yes | **Use.** |
| **Seller: edit / delete / archive product, analytics, views** | No endpoint | **Not shown.** Dashboard stats are computed only from real products and variants. |
| **Multiple currencies** | Product stores its own currency | **Show each product in its own currency.** Fake conversion removed. |

# 3. Design system

Direction: **warm, editorial, confident** - the feel of Zara / COS / Everlane. Photography does the talking; the interface stays quiet with generous white space, one strong accent and thin hairlines. Replaces both existing themes with one.

## Colour palette (light, with a matching dark mode)

**Ivory**
#FAF7F2
page background

**Bone**
#F0EAE0
cards, image wells

**Ink**
#1A1815
text, primary buttons

**Stone**
#6F685D
secondary text

**Clay**
#B5532F
accent: sale, links, hover

**Olive**
#3B4A3A
in-stock, success

**Hairline**
#E4DDD0
borders, dividers

**Brick**
#B0443C
errors, out of stock

- **Why this palette:** ivory + ink is the proven fashion-retail base (images pop, nothing competes with garments). Clay is a warm terracotta that works with both denim/earth tones and bright sneakers, and it is distinct from the generic blue/purple used by tech sites. Olive gives a calm, natural 'in stock' signal instead of loud green.
- **Accessibility:** Ink on Ivory is about 16:1. Clay on Ivory is about 4.6:1 (passes WCAG AA for text). Focus rings use Clay with a 2px offset.
- **Dark mode:** follows the visitor's system setting as today. Bg #121110, surface #1B1917, ink #F3EFE8, accent lightens to #D98A63, olive to #8FA68A. Same tokens, no per-page overrides.

## Typography, shape and motion tokens

| Token | Value |
|---|---|
| **Display font** | Playfair Display (already loaded) for product titles and hero; large, tight, with italic accent words |
| **Body / UI font** | Plus Jakarta Sans (already loaded). Eyebrows: 11px, uppercase, 0.18em tracking |
| **Radius** | Sharp 2px for images and cards (editorial look); 999px only for chips/pills |
| **Spacing scale** | 4 / 8 / 12 / 16 / 24 / 32 / 48 / 72 / 112 px; page gutters 20px mobile, 48px desktop; max width 1360px |
| **Elevation** | Almost flat. Hairline borders; soft shadow only on overlays (search panel, drawer, toast) |
| **Motion tokens** | ease-out-expo cubic-bezier(.16,1,.3,1); durations 180ms (micro), 450ms (reveal), 900ms (hero) |
| **Breakpoints** | 480 / 768 / 1024 / 1360. Product grid: 2 cols mobile, 3 tablet, 4 desktop |

# 4. Shared components (one source of truth)

Today each page re-implements its own header, footer, toast and modal with a different class prefix. I will extract them once and delete the duplicates (including the 250-line page-chrome mixin and the !important overrides).

| Component | What it does |
|---|---|
| **Navbar** | Sticky; transparent over the hero, turns solid with a hairline on scroll. Left: VENDRA wordmark. Centre: Shop (all products), New Arrivals. Right: Search icon (opens overlay), Account (name when signed in / Sign in), Seller dashboard link for sellers only, Bag with live count. Mobile: hamburger drawer with search field at top. Bag badge bounces when count changes. |
| **Announcement bar** | Thin top strip with the shipping/returns promise (text from storefront.js). Dismissible per session. |
| **Footer** | Wordmark, short about line, links ONLY to real routes (Shop, Bag, Sign in, Create account, Seller dashboard for sellers). Dead anchors removed. |
| **Toast system** | One provider replacing four copy-pasted toasts. Stacks, auto-dismiss, success / error variants, aria-live. |
| **Product card** | One card used on Home, Search, Related. 4:5 image, second image fades in on hover (when product has 2+ images), price in product's currency, 'Low stock' / 'Sold out' badge from real variant stock, quick 'Add' bar slides up on hover (desktop) with size/variant chooser when more than one variant exists. |
| **Skeletons** | Shimmer placeholders for product grid, product detail, cart and order pages. |
| **Empty / error states** | Illustrated line-icon empty states with a clear next action; friendly error + retry. |
| **Buttons / fields** | Solid (ink), outline, text-link with animated underline; fields with floating label, visible focus ring, inline validation text. |
| **Reveal helper** | useReveal hook (IntersectionObserver) adds a fade-up when sections scroll into view. Honors prefers-reduced-motion. |
| **NotFound page** | Simple 404 with link back to Shop (new route, no backend). |

# 5. Search redesign

Backend has no search API, so search runs client-side on the product list already loaded by the app. The UX becomes the product:

| Feature | Behaviour |
|---|---|
| **Overlay opened from the navbar** | Click the search icon or press / or Ctrl+K (Cmd+K on Mac). Full-width panel slides down from the header, input auto-focused, Esc closes, background dims. |
| **Live suggestions** | As you type (150ms debounce) show up to 6 product matches with thumbnail, title with the matched text highlighted, and price. Arrow keys move, Enter opens the product, Shift+Enter or 'See all results' goes to the results page. |
| **Smarter matching** | Case/accent-insensitive, multi-word (all words must match), searches title, description and variant attribute values (e.g. 'black M'). Ranked: title-start > title-contains > attribute > description. Light typo tolerance for words of 5+ letters. |
| **Before typing** | Recent searches (saved only in this browser's localStorage, removable with an x, 'Clear all') and 'New arrivals' picked from the newest real products. No invented trending terms. |
| **No results** | Clear message, shows the query, offers to clear it and shows newest products instead. |
| **Results page /search?q=** | Shareable URL. Product grid, result count, sort (relevance, newest, price low/high), price-range slider built from real min/max prices, 'In stock only' toggle, filter chips for attribute values that exist in the data (Size, Colour...). Active filters shown as removable chips. Filter drawer on mobile. |
| **Home integration** | The old inline search box and decorative Cmd+K badge are removed; the overlay is the single entry point everywhere. |
| **Accessibility** | role=combobox / listbox, aria-activedescendant, aria-live result count, visible focus. |

# 6. Home page and animation plan

Animation is concentrated on Home, with lighter touches elsewhere. All motion is CSS/IntersectionObserver based, GPU-friendly (transform and opacity only), and disabled for visitors with 'reduce motion'.

| Section (top to bottom) | Content source | Animation |
|---|---|---|
| **1. Hero** | Full-bleed image carousel built from the newest products' real images; headline 'New season, now in' (copy from storefront.js); current product title + price + 'Shop now' link. | Word-by-word headline rise; slow Ken Burns zoom on the image; crossfade every 6s with progress bar; subtle parallax on scroll; CTA arrow slides on hover. |
| **2. Moving ticker** | Shipping / returns / secure payment lines from storefront.js (only promises the app already makes). | Infinite marquee, pauses on hover. |
| **3. New arrivals** | Latest 8 products from the API in a horizontal scroll-snap rail with prev/next buttons. | Cards fade-up with stagger; drag/scroll with momentum; hover swaps to second image. |
| **4. Featured spotlight** | Large split layout of one real product (newest with 2+ images): gallery, price, 'View product'. | Image reveals with a clip-path wipe; text slides in; image slowly scales on hover. |
| **5. Shop all** | Full grid with sort (newest, price) and 'In stock only' toggle. Skeleton shimmer while loading; empty state if the store has no products. | Cards stagger in on scroll; sort change cross-fades the grid; layout toggle 2/3/4 columns on desktop. |
| **6. Sell with us (sellers only / signed-out CTA)** | Link to /register or /seller/create-product depending on the user's role (real routes). | Soft background colour shift on scroll. |
| **7. Footer** | Real links only. | Link underline sweep. |

## Micro-interactions across the site

- **Add to bag:** product thumbnail flies to the bag icon, badge bounces, toast confirms; button shows a spinner then a check.
- **Buttons:** ink fill sweeps left-to-right on hover; 1px press-down on click.
- **Navbar:** shrinks and gains a hairline after 40px of scroll; mobile drawer slides with staggered links.
- **Product detail:** image gallery crossfades; hover-zoom lens on desktop; swatch ring animates on select; sticky Add-to-bag bar on mobile.
- **Cart:** quantity number flips on change; totals count up/down smoothly; items fade out gracefully on updates.
- **Order success:** existing check-draw and confetti kept, recoloured to the new palette.
- **Route changes:** 250ms fade/slide between pages; scroll restores to top.
- **Loading:** shimmer skeletons everywhere instead of blank space.

Clothing / footwear flavour: the hero and rails are driven by product photography, the ticker and spotlight use editorial typography (large serif, italic accents), and swatches/size pills mimic real store fitting-room selectors. No stock illustrations or fake imagery.

# 7. Page-by-page plan

## 7.1 Home

| | |
|---|---|
| **Route** | / |
| **Keep (logic)** | useProduct.handleGetAllProducts, useCart add/get, Redux selectors. |
| **Redesign** | Full layout per section 6; shared Navbar/Footer; new product card; skeleton + empty states. |
| **Remove** | Sample products, currency selector with fake rates, USD equivalents, category tabs, 'Authenticated' / provenance badges, truncated seller-id, dead Quick View modal, stray '-- Quick View Modal --' text, decorative Cmd+K. |
| **Add (backend-backed)** | Hero carousel, ticker, new-arrivals rail, spotlight, sort, in-stock filter, search overlay. |

## 7.2 Product details

| | |
|---|---|
| **Route** | /product/:productId |
| **Keep (logic)** | Variant matching (colour/size/other attributes), stock logic, add-to-bag. |
| **Redesign** | Two-column editorial layout: large gallery with thumbnails/zoom (left), sticky info panel (right). Clay-accented selected swatch, size pills with strike-through when sold out, stock message from real stock, accordion for Description. Breadcrumb. Mobile: swipeable gallery + sticky bottom bar. |
| **Remove** | Fake MRP (price x 2.85), default '65% OFF', hard-coded size-chart table and 'Fit note', wishlist heart, 'Haute Couture Collection' label, fake 'Buy Now' toast (becomes real: adds to bag then opens /cart). |
| **Add (backend-backed)** | 'More from this seller' and 'New arrivals' rail using real products; share/copy-link button; per-variant price update. |

## 7.3 Cart

| | |
|---|---|
| **Route** | /cart (login required) |
| **Keep (logic)** | Increment / decrement, Razorpay create + verify, price-change message, order snapshot. |
| **Redesign** | Clean line-item list with image, title, variant chips, qty stepper, line price; sticky order-summary card; checkout button with loading state; skeletons. |
| **Remove** | Promo code box (and fake 10% discount), wishlist heart, trash button (no remove endpoint), truncated seller id chip, 'Estimated tax calculated at checkout' filler, 'authentic by atelier specialists' copy. |
| **Add (backend-backed)** | Free-shipping/returns line from storefront.js, smooth quantity transitions, empty-bag state with newest products. |

## 7.4 Order success

| | |
|---|---|
| **Route** | /order-success?order_id= |
| **Keep (logic)** | All current logic (server data, snapshot fallback, verified-only confirmation). |
| **Redesign** | Recolour to new palette; keep tracker, facts, items, print receipt. |
| **Remove** | 'Verified by atelier specialists' policy line; hard-coded 5-7 day delivery estimate unless you confirm it is real policy. |
| **Add (backend-backed)** | Nothing new. |

## 7.5 Login

| | |
|---|---|
| **Route** | /login |
| **Keep (logic)** | useAuth.handleLogin, role-based redirect, Google OAuth link. |
| **Redesign** | Split screen: left = editorial image panel built from latest real product photos (falls back to a plain Bone panel with the wordmark if none); right = clean form with floating labels, show/hide password, inline error. |
| **Remove** | Fake phone mockups with invented products, '4.98 rating (84 orders)', '$3.8M traded', 'Apple' button, 'Forgot password' link, 'Remember me' toggle, dead terms links. |
| **Add (backend-backed)** | Redirect back to the page the user came from (e.g. back to cart) after login. |

## 7.6 Register

| | |
|---|---|
| **Route** | /register |
| **Keep (logic)** | useAuth.handleRegister, seller toggle, Google OAuth. |
| **Redesign** | Same split layout; fields: name, email, contact, password with strength hint; seller option explained in plain words. |
| **Remove** | Same fake showcase content as Login, 'Seller Hub' badge copy about payouts/analytics that do not exist. |
| **Add (backend-backed)** | Password strength meter (client-side only). |

## 7.7 Seller dashboard

| | |
|---|---|
| **Route** | /seller/dashboard (seller) |
| **Keep (logic)** | useProduct.handleGetSellerProduct. |
| **Redesign** | Admin-style but on-brand: stat cards, searchable product table/grid toggle, row shows image, title, price, variant count, total stock with low-stock tag. |
| **Remove** | DEFAULT_PREVIEW_PRODUCTS and 'Load curated samples', fake KPIs, status filter, Archive, Share link, currency selector with fake rates, trust banner copy. |
| **Add (backend-backed)** | Real stats only: product count, variant count, total units in stock, inventory value (sum of price x stock per currency). Empty state with 'Create your first product'. |

## 7.8 Create product

| | |
|---|---|
| **Route** | /seller/create-product (seller) |
| **Keep (logic)** | FormData upload (up to 7 images), handleCreateProduct. |
| **Redesign** | Single-column form with live preview card (how it will look in the shop), drag-and-drop upload with reorder-by-remove thumbnails, inline validation, currency default INR. |
| **Remove** | Left panel with sample couture cards and '3.8M items listed' stats; broken /my-listings link (now goes to dashboard). |
| **Add (backend-backed)** | Character counter, image size/type validation (5MB limit already enforced by backend). |

### 7.9 Seller product details

| | |
|---|---|
| **Route** | /seller/product/:productId (seller) |
| **Keep (logic)** | Add-variant form (images, stock, price, attributes JSON), variant list. |
| **Redesign** | Restyle to shared system; variant cards with image, attributes as chips, stock, price; add-variant as a slide-over panel; attribute entry as key/value rows instead of raw text. |
| **Remove** | Any placeholder copy that is not data. |
| **Add (backend-backed)** | Link to 'view in shop' (real route). |

### 7.10 New: Search results and 404

| | |
|---|---|
| **Route** | /search, * |
| **Keep (logic)** | - |
| **Redesign** | See section 5 and section 4. |
| **Remove** | - |
| **Add (backend-backed)** | Both are frontend-only and use existing data. |

# 8. Hardcoded / fake content that will be removed

| File | Item removed |
|---|---|
| **Home.jsx** | CURATED_SAMPLE_PRODUCTS (3 fake products), CURRENCY_RATES and USD equivalent, category filters guessed from words in titles, fallback seller id '6ad1a7...229e', hard-coded '/images/designer_bomber_jacket.jpg' fallback, favourites, dead quick-view modal, stray text node |
| **ProductDetails.jsx** | calculatedMrp (price x 2.85), discount fallback 65, size-chart table, 'Haute Couture Collection', wishlist, fake Buy Now toast |
| **Cart.jsx** | Promo code + 10% discount, wishlist, trash toast, seller-id chip, hard-coded Razorpay key (moved to env, see section 12) |
| **Dashboard.jsx** | DEFAULT_PREVIEW_PRODUCTS, 'Load Curated Samples', KPIs 1,420 / 84 / +2 / 3 salons / '100% Verified', status filter, archive, currency rates, fallback seller id |
| **CreateProduct.jsx** | sampleCards (Valentino/Mugler fake items), stats '3.8M+ Items', '200K+ Collectors', broken /my-listings link |
| **Login.jsx / Register.jsx** | Fake phone showcase (products, ratings, volumes), Apple button, Forgot password, Remember me |
| **OrderSuccess.jsx** | 'Verified by atelier specialists' text; fixed delivery estimate (pending your answer) |
| **index.html** | Title 'Register & Join the Marketplace' (replaced with a proper store title and description) |
| **public/images/*.jpg** | No longer referenced as fake product fallbacks. Replaced by a neutral Bone placeholder block with the wordmark when an image fails. |
| **SCSS** | All six legacy dark-theme sheets and the page-chrome mixin are rewritten onto the shared tokens; inline style={{}} and !important hacks removed. |

# 9. Implementation phases and files

| Phase | Work | Main files |
|---|---|---|
| **1. Foundation** | Tokens (colour, type, spacing, motion), reset, utilities, ToastProvider, Reveal hook, storefront.js, index.html title/meta, 404 route. | styles/_tokens.scss, styles/base.scss, components/ui/*, config/storefront.js, app.routes.jsx |
| **2. Shell** | Navbar (+ mobile drawer), announcement bar, Footer, page transition, scroll restoration. | components/layout/* |
| **3. Search** | Search overlay, matching/ranking utility, /search page with filters. | features/search/*, utils/searchProducts.js |
| **4. Home** | Hero carousel, ticker, rail, spotlight, grid, skeletons, product card. | features/products/pages/Home.jsx, components/product/*, styles/home.scss |
| **5. Product + Cart + Success** | Product details, cart, order success restyle; remove fake features. | ProductDetails.jsx, Cart.jsx, OrderSuccess.jsx + scss |
| **6. Auth** | Login and Register split-screen redesign. | Login.jsx, Register.jsx, styles/auth.scss |
| **7. Seller** | Dashboard, Create product, Seller product details. | Dashboard.jsx, CreateProduct.jsx, SellerProductDetails.jsx + scss |
| **8. Polish** | Responsive pass (360 / 768 / 1024 / 1440), a11y pass, reduced-motion, dark mode, cleanup of unused SCSS/assets. | all |

# 10. Verification

- **vite build** and **eslint** must pass with no new warnings.
- I will run the app and walk every route at mobile and desktop widths, in light and dark, checking console errors, loading/empty/error states and the full buy flow (add to bag, quantity change, checkout screen).
- Search tested with: no input, partial words, multi-word, no match, keyboard-only.
- Lighthouse accessibility check on Home and Product pages; animations checked with reduced-motion enabled.

- I will report anything I could not verify (for example a live Razorpay payment, which needs your account).

# 11. Decisions I need from you

If you simply reply **'approved'**, I will use the first option (recommended) for each.

| # | Question | Options |
|---|---|---|
| **1** | Colour palette | **A (recommended):** Ivory / Ink / Clay terracotta / Olive as shown in section 3.<br>B: Cool stone white / Ink / Deep navy accent.<br>C: Pure white / black / single bright red accent (more streetwear). |
| **2** | Animation tooling | **A (recommended):** CSS + IntersectionObserver, no new dependency.<br>B: add the 'motion' (Framer Motion) package for page transitions and the fly-to-bag effect. |
| **3** | Shipping / returns / payment strip | These promises already appear in your app ('Free shipping', 'Easy 7-day returns', 'Secure payment via Razorpay'). **A (recommended):** keep exactly these three, stored in storefront.js.<br>B: remove the strip entirely.<br>Tell me if any of the three is not real policy. |
| **4** | New frontend-only pages | **A (recommended):** add /search results page and a 404 page.<br>B: overlay search only, no results page. |
| **5** | Order success delivery estimate (5-7 days) | **A (recommended):** remove it unless you confirm it is real.<br>B: keep it, tell me the correct window. |

# 12. Backend gaps I noticed (not changing them)

These are outside the 'UI only' scope. I will not touch the backend unless you ask, but they limit what the UI can offer:

| Gap | Effect | Suggested follow-up |
|---|---|---|
| **No GET /api/cart/payment/order/:id route, but cart.api.js calls it** | Order success silently falls back to the snapshot saved in the browser. Works, but a different device or cleared storage shows 'could not confirm'. | Add the route. |
| **No cart remove endpoint** | Users cannot delete a line item. | Add DELETE /cart/:productId/:variantId. |
| **No category / gender field on Product** | No Men / Women / Shoes browsing. | Add category + gender to the schema and seller form; the UI then gains real category navigation. |
| **No logout, order history, wishlist, promo endpoints** | Those features are absent from the UI. | Add when needed. |
| **No product edit / delete / stock update** | Sellers cannot fix a listing. | Add PATCH/DELETE for products and variants. |
| **Razorpay test key hardcoded in Cart.jsx** | Key is public (publishable) but should be configurable per environment. | I will move it to VITE_RAZORPAY_KEY_ID in the frontend .env as part of Phase 5 if you agree. |
| **Product list is not paginated** | Fine now; slows as the catalogue grows. | Add ?page&limit; to GET /products. |

**Next step:** tell me 'approved' (or your changes to the five decisions above) and I will start with Phase 1.